defeated in Imphal, but the war they waged was a major influence on our eventual freedom.

Sunderlal Bahuguna, with his Chipko Movement, spearheaded the environment protection and conservation movement at a time when not many were concerned about the plunder of natural resources and its adverse effects.

Arunachalam Muruganantham, the Padman of India, in his zeal to provide his wife with hygienic and affordable sanitary pads, brought about a revolution for rural women by devising the technology to make affordable sanitary pads.

SEWA has created a thriving bank for rural entrepreneurs; Sonam Wangchuk has brought about a knowledge and lifestyle revolution for the people of Ladakh and beyond through his scientific breakthroughs and inventions. Educator Anand Kumar, through his Super-30 coaching programme, has enabled severely underprivileged children to achieve their potential and make their dreams come true.

Incredible individuals who won glory for the nation, along with ordinary citizens who do their duty each day, need to be celebrated. Incredibles like the ‘Flying Sikh’ Milkha Singh, PT Usha, hockey legend Dhyan Chand, tennis great Ramanathan Krishnan, spin maestro Bishan Singh Bedi, king of the shuttlecock Prakash Padukone and chess grandmaster Viswanathan Anand have made the nation proud.

This book commemorates the lives of seventy-five such Indians who can be considered the builders of modern India. Being a living entity, a nation’s future generations must step up and learn from the lives of their incredible ancestors.

The extraordinary deeds of these ordinary Indians made an incredible nation. As we celebrate the seventy-fifth anniversary of our Independence, let us acknowledge these Indians and dedicate ourselves to emulate their deeds and do our bit to make India even more incredible!

Vande Mataram!

**Tushar A Gandhi**